ADMINISTRATION, ECONOMY & SOCIETY UNDER THE SULTANATE

SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY → STATE FORMATION AS A → CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY → IQTA FISCAL-MILITARY FLOW → REVENUE AND LOCAL HIERARCHY → ARMY, LOGISTICS AND URBAN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY

SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY · 13TH C. · CONSOLIDATION THROUGH COURT, IQTA AND INHERITED LOCAL STRUCTURES · ALAUDDIN TIGHTENS REVENUE, CAVALRY AND MARKET SUPERVISION · SHARING, ASSESSMENT, CASH DEMANDS AND HIGH-RISK EXPERIMENTS · CANALS, KARKHANAS, ELITE CONCILIATION AND HEREDITARY DRIFT · 15TH C. · WEAKER DELHI CONTROL AND STRONGER REGIONAL LANDED INTERESTS

13th c. → consolidation through court, iqta and inherited local structures → 1296-1316 → Alauddin tightens revenue, cavalry and market supervision → 1320s-1351 → sharing, assessment, cash demands and high-risk experiments → 1351-1388 → canals, karkhanas, elite conciliation and hereditary drift → 15th c. → weaker Delhi control and stronger regional landed interests

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE
- 13th c. → consolidation through court, iqta and inherited local structures
- 1296-1316 → Alauddin tightens revenue, cavalry and market supervision
- 1320s-1351 → sharing, assessment, cash demands and high-risk experiments

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION
- 1351-1388 → canals, karkhanas, elite conciliation and hereditary drift
- 15th c. → weaker Delhi control and stronger regional landed interests
- RULE: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.

IMPACT / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Iqta, muqti, kharaj, jizya and central diwans must be matched to their precise fiscal-administrative functions.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.

01

STAGE 01 STATE FORMATION AS A LAYERED NETWORK

STATE FORMATION AS A LAYERED NETWORK · SOVEREIGNTY, APPOINTMENTS, CAMPAIGN DIRECTION · CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS · FINANCE, ARMY, CORRESPONDENCE AND INTELLIGENCE · TROOPS, COLLECTION AND PROVINCIAL BARGAINING · VILLAGE ACCESS, INFORMATION AND MEDIATION · PRODUCTION, LABOUR AND TAXABLE SURPLUS · COERCIVE AT NODES, NEGOTIATED ACROSS THE COUNTRYSIDE.

SULTAN / COURT → sovereignty, appointments, campaign direction → CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS → finance, army, correspondence and intelligence → IQTADARS / GOVERNORS → troops, collection and provincial bargaining → KHUTS / MUQADDAMS / CHIEFS → village access, information and mediation → CULTIVATORS / ARTISANS → production, labour and taxable surplus

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- SULTAN / COURT → sovereignty, appointments, campaign direction
- CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS → finance, army, correspondence and intelligence

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- IQTADARS / GOVERNORS → troops, collection and provincial bargaining
- KHUTS / MUQADDAMS / CHIEFS → village access, information and mediation

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CULTIVATORS / ARTISANS → production, labour and taxable surplus
- VERDICT: coercive at nodes, negotiated across the countryside.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: coercive at nodes, negotiated across the countryside.

02

STAGE 02 CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY CAUTION

CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY CAUTION · FINANCE, ACCOUNTS AND REVENUE SUPERVISION · ARIZ-I MAMALIK · MUSTER, HORSES, EQUIPMENT AND PAY · ROYAL CORRESPONDENCE AND CHANCERY · RELIGIOUS-GRANT OR DIPLOMATIC PORTFOLIO IS HISTORIOGRAPHICALLY DEBATED · GRANTS, LEARNED AUTHORITY AND JUDICIAL FUNCTIONS · INTELLIGENCE, REPORTS AND COMMUNICATION

WIZARAT / WAZIR → finance, accounts and revenue supervision → ARZ / ARIZ-I MAMALIK → muster, horses, equipment and pay → INSHA → royal correspondence and chancery → RISALAT → religious-grant or diplomatic portfolio is historiographically debated → SADR / QAZI → grants, learned authority and judicial functions

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE
- WIZARAT / WAZIR → finance, accounts and revenue supervision
- ARZ / ARIZ-I MAMALIK → muster, horses, equipment and pay
- INSHA → royal correspondence and chancery

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION
- RISALAT → religious-grant or diplomatic portfolio is historiographically debated
- SADR / QAZI → grants, learned authority and judicial functions
- BARID → intelligence, reports and communication

IMPACT / LIMIT
- RULE: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.

03

STAGE 03 IQTA FISCAL-MILITARY FLOW

IQTA FISCAL-MILITARY FLOW · CROWN ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM · IQTADAR COLLECTS AUTHORISED SALARY + TROOPS + LOCAL ADMINISTRATION · SURPLUS EXPECTED FOR THE CENTRE TRANSFER RESTRAINS LOCAL ROOTS · ASSIGNMENT OF REVENUE WAS NOT UNRESTRICTED OWNERSHIP OF LAND.

CROWN ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM → MUQTI / IQTADAR COLLECTS authorised salary + troops + local → weak control encourages heredity → RULE: assignment of revenue was not unrestricted ownership of land.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- CROWN ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM → MUQTI / IQTADAR COLLECTS authorised salary + troops + local administration accounts and
- weak control encourages heredity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- RULE: assignment of revenue was not unrestricted ownership of land.
- CROWN ASSIGNS REVENUE CLAIM → MUQTI / IQTADAR COLLECTS authorised salary + troops + local administration accounts and

DEBATE / LEGACY
- weak control encourages heredity
- RULE: assignment of revenue was not unrestricted ownership of land.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: assignment of revenue was not unrestricted ownership of land.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: assignment of revenue was not unrestricted ownership of land.

04

STAGE 04 REVENUE AND LOCAL HIERARCHY

REVENUE AND LOCAL HIERARCHY · LEGAL TERMS · KHARAJ + USHR + ZAKAT + JIZYA + KHAMS · ASSESSMENT, EXEMPTIONS, CASH/KIND AND COLLECTION VARY BY REGION · LOCAL ELITES · KHUTS + MUQADDAMS + CHAUDHURIS + CHIEFS + ACCOUNTANTS · MEASUREMENT, KHALISA EXPANSION AND PRESSURE ON PRIVILEGES · SHARING, OFFICIAL YIELDS, CANALS AND CHANGING INCIDENCE

LEGAL TERMS → kharaj + ushr + zakat + jizya + khams + varied cesses

PRACTICE → assessment, exemptions, cash/kind and collection vary by region → LOCAL ELITES → khuts + muqaddams + chaudhuris + chiefs + accountants → ALAUDDIN → measurement, khalisa expansion and pressure on privileges

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- LEGAL TERMS → kharaj + ushr + zakat + jizya + khams + varied cesses
- PRACTICE → assessment, exemptions, cash/kind and collection vary by region
- LOCAL ELITES → khuts + muqaddams + chaudhuris + chiefs + accountants

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- ALAUDDIN → measurement, khalisa expansion and pressure on privileges
- TUGHLAQS → sharing, official yields, canals and changing incidence
- OUTCOME → surplus transfer plus uneven burden, flight and resistance

DEBATE / LEGACY
- METHOD: distinguish legal category, nominal rate and lived collection.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: METHOD: distinguish legal category, nominal rate and lived collection.

05

STAGE 05 ARMY, LOGISTICS AND URBAN REGULATION

ARMY, LOGISTICS AND URBAN REGULATION · IMPORT ROUTES, BRANDING, INSPECTION AND FODDER · CASH SALARIES · COIN SUPPLY, PRICE CONDITIONS AND TREASURY CAPACITY · FRONTIER DEFENCE, MESSENGERS AND GRAIN MOVEMENT · MARKET OVERSIGHT · WEIGHTS, SUPPLIES, INTELLIGENCE AND PUNISHMENT · POLICING AND JUDICIAL PLURALITY IN TOWNS

HORSES / REMOUNTS → import routes, branding, inspection and fodder

CASH SALARIES → coin supply, price conditions and treasury capacity → FORTS / ROADS → frontier defence, messengers and grain movement → MARKET OVERSIGHT → weights, supplies, intelligence and punishment

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- HORSES / REMOUNTS → import routes, branding, inspection and fodder
- CASH SALARIES → coin supply, price conditions and treasury capacity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- FORTS / ROADS → frontier defence, messengers and grain movement
- MARKET OVERSIGHT → weights, supplies, intelligence and punishment

DEBATE / LEGACY
- KOTWAL / QAZI → policing and judicial plurality in towns
- LESSON: military power rested on fiscal, commercial and informational systems.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: military power rested on fiscal, commercial and informational systems.

06

STAGE 06 AGRARIAN SURPLUS AND IRRIGATION

AGRARIAN SURPLUS AND IRRIGATION · RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS · VARIABLE CULTIVATION CAPACITY GRAIN AND CASH CROPS · VILLAGE CONSUMPTION + DUES + MARKETABLE SURPLUS STATE, IQTA · PUBLIC WORKS DID NOT DISTRIBUTE GAINS EQUALLY.

RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops → → village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over → extraction town demand and armies grow, while famine and harsh collection expose risk → CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops
- → village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- extraction town demand and armies grow, while famine and harsh collection expose risk
- CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops
- → village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

07

STAGE 07 COINAGE AND MONETISATION EVIDENCE

COINAGE AND MONETISATION EVIDENCE · UNITS AND DENOMINATIONS IN AN EXPANDING MONEY ECONOMY · METAL RANGE, SCARCITY AND REGIONAL VARIATION · AUTHORITY, TITLES AND PUBLIC MONETARY CLAIMS · CASH REVENUE · LINKS COUNTRYSIDE, TREASURY, ARMY AND MERCHANTS · RBI PAGE · OFFICIAL MUSEUM SYNTHESIS, NOT A COMPLETE PRICE OR WELFARE

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
TANKA / JITTAL → units and denominations in an expanding money economy	MINTS / LEGENDS → authority, titles and public monetary claims	RBI PAGE → official museum synthesis, not a complete price or welfare series
GOLD / SILVER / COPPER → metal range, scarcity and regional variation	CASH REVENUE / SALARY → links countryside, treasury, army and merchants	VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

SOURCE / MATERIAL
- TANKA / JITTAL → units and denominations in an expanding money economy
- GOLD / SILVER / COPPER → metal range, scarcity and regional variation

METHOD / DEBATE
- MINTS / LEGENDS → authority, titles and public monetary claims
- CASH REVENUE / SALARY → links countryside, treasury, army and merchants

HISTORICAL RESULT
- RBI PAGE → official museum synthesis, not a complete price or welfare series
- VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

08

STAGE 08 URBAN CRAFT AND TECHNOLOGY CIRCUIT

URBAN CRAFT AND TECHNOLOGY CIRCUIT · COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND · CAMBAY AND SMALLER QASBAS TEXTILES + PAPER + METAL · GREATER OUTPUT AND SPECIALISATION WITHOUT EQUAL GAINS FOR LABOUR.

COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND → DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal → + building crafts + royal karkhanas spinning wheel, carder's bow, improved looms, mortar and water → RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND
- DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal + leather

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- + building crafts + royal karkhanas spinning wheel, carder's bow, improved looms, mortar and water lifting
- RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- COURT + *ARMY* + MERCHANT DEMAND
- DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal + leather

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

09

STAGE 09 TRADE, TRANSPORT AND CREDIT

TRADE, TRANSPORT AND CREDIT · VILLAGE PRODUCERS · BANJARAS AND LOCAL MARKETS · INLAND TOWNS · ADVANCES, EXCHANGE AND MERCHANT FINANCE · TRANSFER AND CREDIT ACROSS DISTANCE · BENGAL PORTS · INDIAN OCEAN EXCHANGE AND TEXTILE EXPORTS

VILLAGE PRODUCERS → banjaras and local markets → inland towns

MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance → HUNDIS → transfer and credit across distance → CAMBAY / BENGAL PORTS → Indian Ocean exchange and textile exports

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- VILLAGE PRODUCERS → banjaras and local markets → inland towns
- MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance
- HUNDIS → transfer and credit across distance

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- CAMBAY / BENGAL PORTS → Indian Ocean exchange and textile exports
- HORSE IMPORTS → military demand links coast, merchants and court
- LIMIT: route activity does not prove uniform prosperity or state control.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: An iqta was not automatically private ownership or hereditary property across every reign and region.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: An iqta was not automatically private ownership or hereditary property across every reign and region.

10

STAGE 10 SOCIAL DIFFERENTIATION WITHOUT STATIC BLOCS

SOCIAL DIFFERENTIATION WITHOUT STATIC BLOCS · MAMLUK/FREEBORN TURK + KHALJI + AFGHAN + TAJIK + · ULAMA + SUFIS + TEMPLES/MOSQUES + PLURAL LOCAL PRACTICE · MERCHANTS + ARTISANS + PEASANTS + INTERMEDIARIES + LABOURERS · OCCUPATIONAL CONTINUITY, ADAPTATION, MOBILITY AND EXCLUSION · MILITARY + DOMESTIC + PRODUCTIVE FORMS; NOT ONE ATLANTIC · ELITE/PROPERTY/HOUSEHOLD AND COMMON LABOUR AGENCY DIFFER · HINDU AND MUSLIM SOCIETIES WERE NEITHER SEALED NOR HOMOGENEOUS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
ELITES → mamluk/freeborn Turk + Khalji + Afghan + Tajik + Indian Muslim	VARNA / JATI → occupational continuity, adaptation, mobility and exclusion	RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.
RELIGIOUS → ulama + Sufis + temples/mosques + plural local practice	SLAVERY → military + domestic + productive forms; not one Atlantic analogy	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Administrative ideals, chronicler prescriptions and uneven local practice must remain analytically separate.
ECONOMY → merchants + artisans + peasants + intermediaries + labourers	GENDER → elite/property/household and common labour agency differ	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- ELITES → mamluk/freeborn Turk + Khalji + Afghan + Tajik + Indian Muslim
- RELIGIOUS → ulama + Sufis + temples/mosques + plural local practice
- ECONOMY → merchants + artisans + peasants + intermediaries + labourers

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- VARNA / JATI → occupational continuity, adaptation, mobility and exclusion
- SLAVERY → military + domestic + productive forms; not one Atlantic analogy
- GENDER → elite/property/household and common labour agency differ

DEBATE / LEGACY
- RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Administrative ideals, chronicler prescriptions and uneven local practice must remain analytically separate.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.

11

STAGE 11 TOPIC 07 EVIDENCE AND ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 07 EVIDENCE AND ANSWER SPINE · CHANGING MILITARY-FISCAL STATE, CENTRALISING IN ASPIRATION · COURT + DEPARTMENTS + IQTA + LOCAL INTERMEDIARIES · AGRARIAN SURPLUS + MONEY + TOWNS + CRAFTS + · LAYERED ELITES, LABOUR, CASTE, COMMUNITY, SLAVERY AND GENDER · CHRONICLERS + TRAVELLERS + COINS + INSCRIPTIONS + MONUMENTS · NEGOTIATED IN PRACTICE, REGIONALLY UNEVEN AND SOCIALLY UNEQUAL.

OPEN → changing military-fiscal state, centralising in aspiration → ADMIN → court + departments + iqta + local intermediaries → ECONOMY → agrarian surplus + money + towns + crafts + trade → SOCIETY → layered elites, labour, caste, community, slavery and gender → METHOD → chroniclers + travellers + coins + inscriptions + monuments

SOURCE / MATERIAL
- OPEN → changing military-fiscal state, centralising in aspiration
- ADMIN → court + departments + iqta + local intermediaries

METHOD / DEBATE
- ECONOMY → agrarian surplus + money + towns + crafts + trade
- SOCIETY → layered elites, labour, caste, community, slavery and gender

HISTORICAL RESULT
- METHOD → chroniclers + travellers + coins + inscriptions + monuments
- CLOSE → negotiated in practice, regionally uneven and socially unequal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → negotiated in practice, regionally uneven and socially unequal.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADMINISTRATION, ECONOMY & SOCIETY UNDER THE SULTANATE — ADVANCED · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · 5. UPSC TRAPS · 6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Administration, Economy & Society under the Sultanate — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept: India as an industrial hub before European dominance
- Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)
- Early Turkish rulers largely left land-revenue collection to Hindu chiefs and existing arrangements

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels